

Being predominantly targeted at the OS/2 platform, Lotus 1-2-3 was slow to adapt to the Windows platform. A plan to completely re-write the application for Windows, when it became available, failed to take off. Moreover, there were various versions of Lotus 1-2-3 available for Windows, each with slightly different functionality and interface. This further fragmented the customer base of the software. In the next three years, Excel had overtaken Lotus 1-2-3 in popularity.

January: An IBM PC Laptop

Weighing in at 12.5 kg, the Compaq Portable was essentially an IBM PC packed into a suitcase-sized casing; it was announced in January 1983. Since the IBM PC was supported by most hardware and software manufacturers, it was considered a safe buy. There were many manufacturers who released their own versions of the PC but made them compatible with the IBM PC so users could take advantage of the hardware upgrades and software titles available for the platform. The Compaq was the first such completely IBM-PC-compatible PC.



The Compaq Portable: would not fit under a plane seat!

The only way Compaq was able to make an IBM PC compatible PC was because IBM outsourced parts of its computer from other manufacturers and Microsoft licensed the MS-DOS to computer manufacturers. Compaq copied the design specifications of the IBM PC, modified them to fit in a suitcase sized box, and bundled a licensed version of CompaqDOS in it.

The biggest contribution of the Compaq Portable is that it is considered the first truly portable computer, an ancestor of